Khadija Abdi

607-537-1233 | ka585@cornell.edu | linkedin.com/in/khali-abdi | Portfolio (khaliabdi.com)

Education

Cornell University **May 2028**
Candidate for Master of Science in Human Environment Relations *Ithaca, NY*
Department of Human Centered Design, Concentration in Environmental Psychology and Human Factors

Research Focus: Equity in health sensor design (cross-skin-tone accuracy) and user trust in health technology
Relevant Coursework: Human Factors & Inclusive Design, Applied Ergonomic Methods, Research Methods, AI Embodiment & Design, Quantitative Methods I

University of Waterloo **May 2025**
Bachelor of Applied Science in Chemical Engineering, Honours, Co-operative Program *Waterloo, ON*

Technical Skills

Human Factors & Research Methods: Usability testing, think-aloud protocols, task analysis, workflow mapping, user interviews, heuristic evaluation, affinity mapping, persona and JTBD development, research ethics protocols
Analysis & Programming: Python (pandas, NumPy), MATLAB, statistical and qualitative data analysis, HTML, JavaScript, ReactJS
Design & Visualization: AutoCAD, SolidWorks, Figma, Power BI

Work Experience

Graduate Research Assistant **September 2026 – Present**
Design + Augmented Intelligence Lab (DAIL) *Ithaca, NY*

- Joined DAIL to research how older adults navigate and respond to built and virtual environments using AR/VR and biometric sensing.

User Experience Researcher **August 2025 – Present**
Allshores Limited *Toronto, ON*

- Mapped end-to-end workflows for **3 patient and provider audiences**, uncovering **10+ usability and experience pain points** that informed feature prioritization for health-related services.
- Designed and implemented **5 feedback collection methods** with Insights and Product teams, aligning stakeholders on user needs ahead of product decisions.
- Created **5 user personas** and early Jobs To Be Done (JTBD) frameworks that guided product and design decisions.

Co-Founder & Product Lead **October 2024 – June 2026**
Mea (formerly Hera) *Waterloo, ON*

- Built a digital support platform for postpartum mental health, translating user needs into peer connection, emotion tracking, and a personalized care guide.
- Selected for the University of Waterloo's Velocity Summer Incubator, receiving venture funding, mentorship, and dedicated product development support.
- Led customer discovery and product validation through **1,000+ survey views** and **20+ interviews** with healthcare experts and target users, using AI-assisted first-pass thematic analysis to synthesize findings into product requirements.

Associate Product Management Intern **January 2024 – August 2024**
The Argus Group *Hamilton, Bermuda*

- Conducted usability testing and **30+ user interviews** across service and product research initiatives, triangulating survey, interview, and observational data to identify navigation and lifecycle gaps.
- Owned formative usability testing with **10 participants**, extracting **12 actionable insights** that drove a redesign cutting navigation time by **20%** on a health benefits tool.
- Developed an MVP roadmap from research findings that secured **$100,000** in funding and consolidated fragmented healthcare booking processes.

Projects

Oxygen-Releasing Hydrogel for Diabetic Wounds | *Final Year Capstone Project* **April 2025**

- Led a **4-person team** through project scope definition, stakeholder identification, and success metrics, coordinating weekly team and supervisor meetings that kept all deliverables on **100% schedule completion.**
- Conducted a literature review on oxygen-generating hydrogel systems that helped inform the team's material selection (calcium peroxide-embedded thiolated gelatin), achieving sustained oxygen release validated at ∼**86%** dissolved oxygen.
- Led social, economic, and sustainability impact analysis, turning technical results into a cost model (**$0.55**–**$8.80/patch**) demonstrating feasibility for equitable deployment in low-resource care settings.